RODI Co-Op Leadership Update

Veronica Ramos Rodriguez
Spring 2025 RODI DS Co-Op

Johnson&Johnson
Innovative Medicine



Veronica Ramos Rodriguez

Rising Senior @ University of Florida

Bachelor's Degree in Biomedical Engineering

- Minors in Electrical Engineering, Computer Science, and Digital Arts & Sciences

SMILE Lab Undergraduate Research Assistant

- MRI Image Segmentation and ML Predictive Diagnosis for Parkinson's Disease & Dementia Research

STAR Lead Mentor

- Assisted first year engineering students with academic, professional, and personal development

UF Jobs/Involvement

- UFIT Research Computing Intern
- Florida Museum of Natural History Mammalogy Research Intern
- Dream Team Engineering Software Team Member

Hobbies

- Tennis
- Bonsai
- Strategy Games



J&J Innovative Medicine

Learnings From Co-op

3D Framework – Project & Team Management

These Questions Manifest in Many Ways…

1 DEFINE

"Why are you doing this?"

- ❑ **G&Os (SMART)**
- ❑ Out of Scope
- ❑ **Success**
- ❑ Operating Model
- ❑ Mission
- ❑ **Problem**

2 DECIDE

"What is your one strategy to deliver?"

- ❑ **Final Action Plan**
- ❑ Technologies
- ❑ Discontinuation Plan
- ❑ Communications
- ❑ Roles & Responsibilities

3 DRIVE

"How are you executing your strategy?"

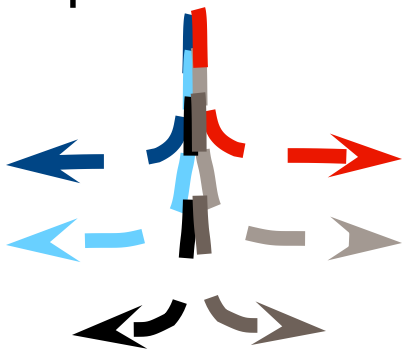
- ❑ Monitoring Progress
- ❑ Post-Release Maintenance
- ❑ Utilizing Momentum
- ❑ Content Promotion
- ❑ Phase Out

Why is this important?

Examples – What happens if we don't follow it?

A Team With No Definition

1. DEFINE Purpose Statement



"A Thousand Flowers"

- Take on Everything
- Stop Nothing
- No Team Cohesion

Limit Achievement

A Project With No Decision

1. DEFINE Problem Statement
2. DECIDE Action Strategy

Business Gathers Requirements for X

IT Begins Planning for Y

Communications is Promoting Z

Project Goes in Circles and **Progress is Limited**

A Program With No Drive

1. DEFINE Success Metrics
2. DECIDE Roles & Responsibilities
3. DRIVE Maintenance

Program is Not Utilized or Kept Up-to-Date and is **Eventually Forgotten**

Exercise - How can we apply this?

Define

"Why do we have a Data Science Think Tank Program?"

Business Objectives

- Support Digital Transformation Strategy
- Build a Data Science Talent Pipeline
- Gain New Viewpoints
- Promote Positive Company Perception

Business Success

- Introduction of new methodologies and diverse perspectives for data-driven decision-making
- Connections with skilled students that could become full-time hires
- Enhancement of the Team's Analytical Capabilities
- Delivery of actionable insights from projects

Student Objectives

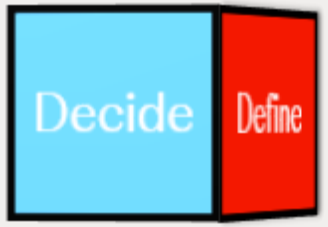
- Career Coaching
- Professional Growth & Networking
- Technical & Managerial Skill Development

Student Success

- Mastering relevant tools, technologies, or methodologies used by the team
- Improved Confidence in Professional Settings
- Meaningful Contributions to Projects
- Increased Clarity on Career Aspirations

How can we apply this?

"What is our action plan to deliver?"



Business Strategy

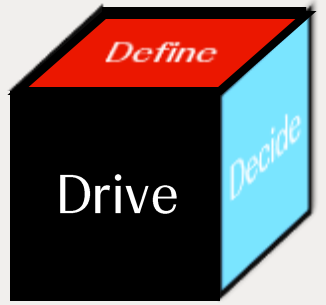
- ❑ Assign interns **valuable and challenging projects** that align with and support our business priorities.
- ❑ Provide **training sessions** designed to enhance the cohort's **analytical skills and technical expertise**, fostering professional growth.
- ❑ Introduce a rotating mentor program that encourages interns to **build connections** and gain insights across multiple areas of the company.
- ❑ Regularly **assess interns' capabilities** to determine their fit for **potential full-time roles** within the organization.
- ❑ **Preparing** for data access and system onboarding issues ahead of time

Student Strategy

- ❑ Actively **propose ideas** during meetings to enhance discussions and drive projects forward
- ❑ Accept opportunities to **work outside comfort zone**, allowing for the **acquisition of new skills**
- ❑ Attend a variety of project meetings to gain insights from J&J professionals and **broaden understanding of topics** relevant to RODI DS
- ❑ Engage with colleagues across various departments to learn about their roles and explore potential **future career paths**
- ❑ Note **areas for improvement** and maintain a running list of possible recommendations for **future enhancements**

How can we apply this?

“How are we executing that?”



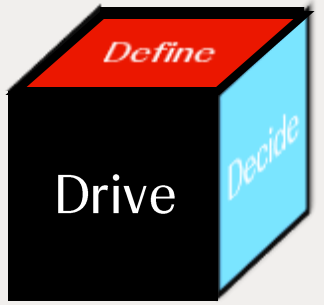
Recommendations for Business



Recommendations for Students

How can we apply this?

“How are we executing that?”



Agile Methodology

Active Communication

Knowledge Sharing

?

Initiative & Proactivity

Solutions Research

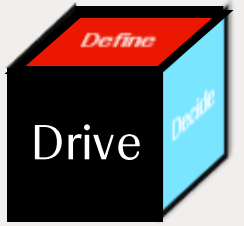
Accountability & Goals

Early Strategizing

Reflection & Flexibility

How can we apply this?

“How are we executing that?”



Agile Methodology

- ❑ Capability Assessment
- ❑ Create Strategies

Active Communication

- ❑ Proposed Ideas
- ❑ Broader Understanding

Knowledge Sharing

- ❑ Technical Growth
- ❑ Build Connections



Initiative & Proactivity

- ❑ Career Planning
- ❑ New Skills

Solutions Research

- ❑ Create Strategies
- ❑ Technical Growth

Accountability & Goals

- ❑ Improvement
- ❑ New Skills

Early Strategizing

- ❑ Meaningful Projects
- ❑ Data/Onboarding Access

Reflection & Flexibility

- ❑ Improvement Recommendations

Thank You!

Special Thank You to Mae Rouhani & Shivani Mehta.

I've learned so much from this experience and am grateful to have been here and been able to work with you all.

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